

Thaddeus Liu

Technical & Programmatic SEO Lead · 15+ Years Scaling Organic Growth Systems

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Summary

15+ years building organic growth systems where templates, structured data, and search-intent mapping replace manual page production. From modular per-word pages at Youdao Dictionary (10K → 200K DAU), to **1.5M POI landing pages** at eLong (~9× non-brand organic orders over 4 years, ~20–30M RMB net profit in the best year), to a **global SEO middle platform** at Alibaba (long-tail non-brand organic < 1K → 200K UV/day, 99.97% of indexed pages found to not earn their existence), to **GEO / AEO** customer-acquisition on Doubao / DeepSeek and other AI assistants today — the through-line is the same: programmatic SEO and content engineering, not manual operation.

Hands-on with the full technical SEO stack — GSC + log file analysis, Screaming Frog, Ahrefs, SEMrush, GA4 + BigQuery — plus self-built crawlers, log parsers, sitemap generators, and schema pipelines for problems off-the-shelf tools don't reach. Comfortable reading HTML/CSS, reviewing CDN and JS-rendering decisions with engineering, and shipping JSON-LD, hreflang, canonicalization, and Core Web Vitals work in production. Now extending the same engineering mindset to LLM-powered search (AI Overviews, answer engines, generative search).

Core Skills

Technical SEO: Crawl/render/index, log file analysis, Core Web Vitals, JSON-LD structured data, hreflang, canonicalization, redirect strategy, site migrations, sitemap & robots architecture

Programmatic SEO at Scale: Template-driven million-page generation, search-intent → page-archetype mapping, entity-based SEO, topical authority, internal linking architecture

AEO / GEO: Brand visibility & acquisition on Doubao / DeepSeek and other AI assistants; AI-Overview / answer-engine / generative-search optimization

Documentation & Developer Content: Wiki/dictionary-pattern IA, developer-intent content roadmaps, search-driven information architecture

SEO Tooling: Google Search Console, Screaming Frog, Ahrefs, SEMrush, GA4, BigQuery, log analysis; self-built crawlers, schema pipelines, sitemap generators, internal-link auditors

Web Fundamentals: HTML/CSS review for SEO issues, HTTP status codes, CDN configuration, DNS, JS-rendered site indexing

Experimentation: Large-scale A/B and multivariate testing, causal evaluation, statistical-significance discipline

Cross-Functional Leadership: Engineering × content × data science × product marketing; influencing platform and infrastructure decisions

Experience

AI Growth Lead (GEO / Content / Growth Products), Leading Automotive Platform May 2026 – present

Owning customer acquisition and brand visibility across AI assistants (GEO/AEO), content marketing, and growth-product infrastructure (landing pages, attribution, postback).

- **GEO / AEO: Built a production GEO program in 2 months** on Doubao / DeepSeek and other Chinese AI assistants for consumer vehicle-lead acquisition. **One of the few production GEO programs in China.**
- **Content marketing at scale: AI + self-built multi-account content network** (self-media / WeChat / video) producing intent-targeted content at search and answer-engine surfaces.
- **Growth-product infrastructure:** Landing-page systems, attribution, postback — the technical foundation behind all organic and paid acquisition.
- **AI Performance Ads** (secondary, rolling out): An AI-driven ad system **designed for** million-RMB-monthly creative generation, launch, budget allocation, and performance accounting. Currently rolling out.

Owned organic + paid acquisition, a production GEO operation, and lead-gen automation across domestic and international business.

- **Ran a production GEO operation on Doubao / DeepSeek and other AI assistants** — the full daily loop from query investigation through content to measurement, across three China-market B2B lines. Attribution closed through a customer-service intake that verified where each client first heard the brand, surfacing AI-assistant discovery. **GEO contribution to orders grew from 10% → ~50%** (peaked at 63%).
- Built **'user scenario → intent keyword → AI categorization → dedicated landing page'** system for paid acquisition. Overall ad efficiency **+3x**, MQL volume **+3.6x**.
- Reverse-engineered user profiles, pain points, and selling points from sales and usage data, driving **MQL +260%**.
- Built sales-signal feedback mechanism and competitor-channel mapping; **non-paid leads +100%**, lead cost -15-40%.

Head of Growth — Subscription Content (International Markets), TouchShort Media July 2024 – Jan 2025 (Chongqing)

Full-funnel growth for an overseas short-drama app; built 0 → scalable user-acquisition system.

- Scaled paid spend 0 → **\$10K/day** with framework proven scalable to **\$100K/day** achieved first-day **ROI 0.6-1.0+** at \$10K/day (industry benchmark ~0.4).
- User-profile-driven landing-page and content restructuring lifted **ROI by 30%**.
- Multilingual localization content pipeline — dramatically improved content supply efficiency across markets.

User Growth Leader (SEA), Lazada (Alibaba Group)

Mar 2022 – Feb 2024

User growth, organic content distribution, and ad operations across Southeast Asia — multi-country, multi-language, multi-culture.

- **Re-architected content and SKU distribution around user location** — kickstart work redefining user profiles, scenarios, USPs, and creative logic delivered **+40% buyers** the location-based distribution itself lifted **conversion rate +50%** (benchmark 5%). Profile-based distribution added **+8-13% CR** in Fashion and Beauty.
- Extracted **100 reusable scenarios from 13M SKU-pair combinations** (3,600 leaf categories × 3,600) — a **user-profile → scenario → top-selling-SKU** intent framework for multi-country, multi-locale content production at scale.
- UX and path redesign: new-user registration **+16%**, first-order conversion **+15-20%**.
- Introduced AI-generated selling-point and scenario creatives — selling-point assets accounted for **90% of spend**, nearly replacing manual creative.
- Ran million-USD controlled A/B experiments with budget held flat: **buyer count +20%** vs. team benchmark of 2%, winning 70% incremental budget.

Built a **global e-commerce SEO middle platform** supporting AliExpress, Alibaba.com, Taobao Overseas, and other global businesses for organic growth — covering hreflang, canonicalization, internal-linking, and schema at multi-country scale.

- **The diagnosis most teams miss.** AliExpress and Alibaba.com had ~5–6 billion indexed pages each. Counting only the pages that actually drive business outcomes (orders on AliExpress, quote requests on Alibaba.com — B2B has no orders), only **~0.03–0.04% earned their existence** — the rest were diluting crawl budget and drowning out the good content. Previous long-tail SEO work had *added* pages, which made the problem worse.
- **Phase 1 — content convergence.** On AliExpress, buyer-side and seller-side product detail pages were both indexed. Removed the redundant set. **Long-tail organic traffic went up ~70K UV/day almost immediately** — a 7× lift on the metric that mattered, with no new content. Sometimes the answer to "more traffic" is "fewer pages."
- **Phase 2 — the SEO middle platform.** Built shared infrastructure — hreflang, canonicalization, schema, sitemaps, internal linking at platform scale — for AliExpress, Alibaba.com, and Taobao Overseas. The principle generalized: stop building parallel per-market systems; build one platform that does it right and every site benefits.
- **Results.** Reversed multi-year organic-traffic decline. Long-tail non-brand organic on AliExpress / Alibaba.com went from < 1,000 UV/day to ~200,000 UV/day. Taobao Overseas long-tail added ~150K UV/day. **Saved 90%+ headcount** vs. the per-market, per-team model. Full-funnel UX optimization lifted organic conversion rate by 10%.

Online Marketing Director — SEO / SEM, eLong (under Expedia; acquired by Ctrip / Trip.com in 2017) Aug 2012 – Aug 2017

Owned scalable organic and paid acquisition for one of China's largest OTAs — non-brand programmatic SEO plus SEM automation at platform scale.

- **Programmatic SEO at scale:** built a **1.5M-POI landing-page system** from Gaode / Baidu map data + eLong's own hotel inventory. One templated page form covering every POI type (airports, hospitals, attractions, transit hubs, businesses); each page answered the traveler decision journey — how to get there, local services within 5km, ≥3 bookable hotels nearby with an interactive map. **~9× growth in non-brand organic orders over 4 years** (2×, 2×, 1.5×, 1.5×), contributing **20–30M RMB annual net profit in the best year**. Internal linking built as opportunities arose: city pages → key POIs; hotel detail pages → nearby POIs.
- **Quality gate, not vibes:** ship-or-not for a POI was the **≥3-bookable-hotels-within-5km rule** — a real business-value condition, not a search-volume threshold. Of 15–20M raw map POIs, the system shipped 1.5M, with ~90% indexed.
- **Discipline signal:** built a 150K-UV/day intracity transit-routes feature, then closed it directly — OTA earned on hotels only, this had zero business value. No escalation needed.
- **SEM automation platform:** replaced a 15-person manual operation with a Ruby on Rails platform and a unified search-engine API abstraction. Steady-state **20M keywords** across Baidu / 360 / Sogou / Soso (now defunct) / Shenma (mobile-only). ROI-based bid adjustment, budget pacing, automated landing-page routing, and Hive-based attribution joining spend to order value at the keyword level. **ROI +50%** vs. the manual baseline; transparent spend-vs-profit became a default view.
- Team evolved from 1 SEO operator + 5 editors to 5 engineers, 0 SEO operators, 0 editors — manual content production was the wrong shape for the page volume needed.

SEO Engineer — Dictionary, Translation, News, Auto, NetEase Youdao

Feb 2011 – Aug 2012

Organic-traffic growth across Youdao Dictionary, Youdao Translation, NetEase News, and NetEase Auto.

- **Templated long-tail SEO for Youdao Dictionary**: built per-word pages (foreign ↔ Chinese) structured around real user search journeys — people looking up a term from their own field of work or study. Each page carried the translation plus definition, examples, and sample sentences, with each content module at its own URL so the right module ranked for the right query. Term corpus from the Sogou input-method Cell of Words (upstream of search — what people type before they search). **Dictionary DAU 10K → 180–200K**. Same modular-page pattern today's developer-documentation SEO uses.
- Translation product brand traffic **+100%**.
- Awarded **Best Employee 4 months after joining**.

Builder / Growth Lead, Global Procurement Database Startup (Overseas)

Sept 2019 – Mar 2022

- Built a B2B global procurement decision-maker database for US/EU markets and a proprietary user-mapping algorithm with substantial overlap against the leading competitor.
- Generated SQL-level contacts for outbound sales and small-scale data export.

Development Lead, Sina Real Estate (Leju)

Jan 2008 – Jan 2011

- Grew from software engineer to development lead. Built front-end and SEO automation systems to improve large-scale content visibility — the technical foundation under everything that came after.

Technical Support Engineer, PeopleCert (Greece)

Jan 2007 – Jan 2008

- Software testing and debugging; on-site technical support for enterprise clients across Europe.

Education

Beijing Jiaotong University, BSc in Information and Computing Science

2002 – 2006